GRADE 12 / Tourism / English

Time zones without guesswork

01 Understand

Learning goals: Convert between UTC offsets • Account for flight duration • Check the calendar date

UTC offsets state how far local time is ahead of or behind UTC. Convert departure time to UTC first, then add elapsed flight time.

Convert the arrival UTC time to the destination’s stated offset. Adjust the date whenever the calculation crosses midnight.

Use the offsets supplied in an exam. For real bookings verify the actual date-specific local time, because some destinations use seasonal clock changes.

Worked route with stated offsets

Step	Calculation	Time
Depart Johannesburg UTC+2	22:00 − 2 h	20:00 UTC
Fly 10 hours	20:00 + 10 h	06:00 UTC next day
Destination UTC+1	06:00 + 1 h	07:00 local next day

02 Follow the reasoning

A flight leaves Johannesburg at 22:00 on Monday, flies 10 hours and arrives at a destination on UTC+1. Find arrival time and day.

1. Departure is Monday 20:00 UTC.
2. Add 10 hours: Tuesday 06:00 UTC.
3. Add the destination’s 1-hour offset: Tuesday 07:00 local time.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. A city is UTC−3. What is its time when UTC is 15:00?

2. A flight departs there at 12:00 and lasts 8 hours. Find arrival UTC.

3. Convert that arrival to Johannesburg at UTC+2.

04 Check and correct

1. 12:00 on the same day.

2. Departure 15:00 UTC; arrival 23:00 UTC the same day.

3. 01:00 the next day.

Common mistake to avoid

Flight duration is elapsed time. Do not subtract it because you are travelling west.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Map work and tour planning: time zones and travel calculations

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: Tourism. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID tour-12.